

The State of Karnataka v. State of Tamil Nadu & Ors. (with connected appeals of State of Kerala and State of Tamil Nadu)

Supreme Court of India · Three-Judge Bench · 16 February 2018 · AIRONLINE 2018 SC 626 · Civil Appeal No. 2453 of 2007, with Civil Appeal Nos. 2454 and 2456 of 2007 · **Appeals disposed of, modifying the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal's water allocation among the riparian States**

HEADNOTE

Not an electricity case — the landmark Cauvery river inter-State water dispute judgment, adjudicating the appeals from the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal's final award under the Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956 and Article 262 of the Constitution, addressing groundwater apportionment, the doctrine of equitable apportionment, and Bangalore's drinking-water needs. Recorded compactly and without exhaustive digest given its complete absence of Supply Code nexus (the Cauvery basin's hydro-electric power generation is not a subject of adjudication in this judgment) and its enormous scale (a multi-hundred-page judgment); noted in this corpus's master citation ledger only because the case was collected among search results for Supply Code-adjacent material.

HOLDING-UNITS

INTERPLAY · OFFTOPIC::cauvery-interstate-water-dispute

Cauvery river water allocation among Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala and Puducherry, modifying the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal's final award

HOLDING

The Supreme Court modified the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal's award, revising the inter-State water-sharing formula (including recognition of Bangalore's drinking-water requirements and groundwater considerations), while broadly upholding the Tribunal's equitable-apportionment framework. No electricity-law question was presented or decided. ¶ not exhaustively digested

LIMITING FACTS

Cross-appeals by Karnataka, Tamil Nadu and Kerala against the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal's final award (2007) apportioning Cauvery river water among the basin States.

FLAG Recorded compactly given its complete absence of electricity/Supply Code nexus and enormous scale (a landmark interstate water-dispute judgment); not exhaustively digested against this corpus's doctrinal framework.